Alder Quay Financial Services Ltd

Travel, Expenses and Gifts Policy

FICTIONAL TRAINING / TEST DOCUMENT - NOT LEGAL ADVICE

Alder Quay Financial Services Ltd is invented. All staff, systems, limits, approvals and company arrangements in this pack are synthetic. No real authorisation, regulatory registration, employment entitlement or product is represented. Use only to test document retrieval and grounded answers.

Document Id: AQ-HR-003

Version: 3.0

Effective Date: 2026-10-01

Review Date: 2027-10-01

Status: Current - synthetic

Classification: Internal - synthetic test data

Owner: Finance Operations

Approver: Fictional Board Policy Committee

Related documents: AQ-HR-002, AQ-HR-004, AQ-CMP-001

Contents and citation guide

1. Purpose and general rules

2. Travel and accommodation

3. Meals and remote working

4. Claims and approvals

5. Gifts and hospitality

6. Monitoring and examples

Cite document ID, version and section number. All versions in this pack are current as of the shared effective date. Change notes refer to fictional history; superseded documents are not supplied.

1. Purpose and general rules

Reimburse reasonable, necessary business costs actually incurred, supported by itemised receipts and business purpose. Limits are fictional internal ceilings, not tax-free allowances or statements of statutory rates

Use the company booking tool where available. Ordinary commuting, fines, personal subscriptions and partner travel are not reimbursable. Never split a claim to evade an approval threshold.

2. Travel and accommodation

Book standard-class rail and economy flights. Flights require manager approval before booking; business class needs CFO approval for a documented accessibility or exceptional operational reason. UK hotel room caps excluding breakfast are GBP 180 per night in London and GBP 130 elsewhere, inclusive of VAT

A higher rate requires prior budget-owner approval with evidence of alternatives. Reasonable accessible travel may exceed ordinary caps through the adjustment process. Personal vehicle business mileage is reimbursed at a fictional flat rate of GBP 0.40 per mile, subject to payroll tax review; no claim is allowed for ordinary commuting.

3. Meals and remote working

When business travel requires an overnight stay, actual meal costs are reimbursable up to GBP 35 per day including VAT and service charges. Alcohol is excluded. No automatic subsistence allowance is payable without receipts

Meals for client events follow the hospitality rules instead of this cap. Home broadband and household utilities are not reimbursed under the standard hybrid arrangement. Approved homeworking equipment is limited to the one-off GBP 250 allowance in AQ-HR-002 section 4.

4. Claims and approvals

Submit claims in ExpenseFlow within 30 calendar days of spending. Claims between 31 and 90 days need Finance Operations approval; older claims require CFO approval and an explanation. Managers approve claims up to and including GBP 500; claims above GBP 500 require the budget owner and Finance Operations

No one may approve their own claim; a manager claim goes to their manager. Payment is targeted within 10 working days after complete approval. A lost receipt requires a declaration and Finance review; acceptance is not automatic.

5. Gifts and hospitality

Cash, cash equivalents and gifts intended to influence decisions are prohibited at any value. Record all offered or received business gifts and hospitality in the Conflicts Register, including declined items. Items up to GBP 50 per person may be accepted with manager approval; above GBP 50 requires Compliance approval in advance

Hospitality above GBP 100 per person requires Compliance approval in advance. Gifts or hospitality involving public officials always require prior Compliance approval regardless of amount. These thresholds never make an improper inducement acceptable. See AQ-CMP-001 section 4.

6. Monitoring and examples

Finance performs monthly duplicate, unusual merchant and threshold checks and refers suspected misconduct under AQ-HR-005. A GBP 500 ordinary travel claim needs manager approval; GBP 500.01 needs the budget owner and Finance Operations

A GBP 55 client gift requires advance Compliance approval, even if the employee intends to pay personally. Expenses are retained for the synthetic seven-year period in AQ-CMP-003 section 5, subject to holds. Version 3.0 changes the London hotel cap to GBP 180; previous values must not be inferred.